

AFRORYTHM

Project Completion File

Creator-First Music Streaming Platform with MTN Mobile Money Monetization

Product Brief, Feature Backlog & Delivery Roadmap

Prepared for Ruby | August 21, 2026

Below is a structured project completion file you can use as the foundation for your app plan, product brief, or project documentation. It includes the market gaps, the full feature set, and a step-by-step priority order for implementation based on what the market needs and what MTN's API stack supports.

Project Completion File

Project Title

Creator-first music streaming platform for young talents with MTN Mobile Money monetization. The product is designed to help emerging artists upload music, grow an audience, and earn directly from fans.

Project Vision

Build a mobile and web platform where unsigned and rising artists can publish music, get discovered, and receive payments easily through MTN Mobile Money. The platform should be lightweight, transparent, and focused on creator earnings instead of only playback volume.

Market Opportunity

The opportunity is strong because recorded music revenue in sub-Saharan Africa is growing while creator monetization problems remain unresolved. That creates room for a platform that combines discovery, direct support, and local payment methods for artists who are under-served by large streaming services.

Key Market Gaps

The market gaps this project should target are:

- Weak monetization for emerging artists.
- Poor visibility for young and local talent.
- Limited local payment integration on creator platforms.
- Low trust in payout transparency.
- Too much focus on large catalogs instead of talent development.
- Limited support for micro-payments and fan tipping.
- Weak promotion tools for unsigned artists.

Product Objectives

1. Help artists upload and manage their music.

2. Help fans discover and support new talent.
3. Enable direct money flow using MTN Mobile Money.
4. Provide payout transparency and earnings tracking.
5. Create a scalable base for future subscriptions, ads, and promotions.

Core User Roles

- Artist: uploads tracks, views earnings, promotes content, requests payouts.
- Listener/Fan: streams tracks, follows artists, tips, subscribes, shares content.
- Admin: approves content, manages disputes, controls moderation, tracks performance.
- Promoter/Curator: features artists, creates playlists, helps discovery.

Full Feature List

1. Artist onboarding

Artists register with profile details, genre, location, and social links. This is important because the platform needs identity, creator segmentation, and a basis for payouts.

2. Music upload system

Artists upload tracks, covers, metadata, and release details. This is the core supply-side feature and should support drafts, publishing, editing, and takedown requests.

3. Artist profile pages

Each artist gets a public profile with music catalog, followers, earnings summary, and featured releases. This helps discovery and makes the platform feel creator-owned.

4. Streaming and playback

Users can play music, pause, skip, queue, and browse tracks. The app should support low-data playback because mobile bandwidth and affordability matter for the target audience.

5. Discovery feed

A personalized discovery feed should surface new artists, trending songs, and local recommendations. This directly targets the market gap where unsigned talent is hard to find.

6. Follow and fan engagement

Fans can follow artists, like songs, comment, and share releases. Engagement features help artists grow organically and give the app a community layer beyond streaming.

7. MTN Mobile Money payments

Users can pay with MTN Mobile Money for tips, subscriptions, premium content, or downloads. MTN's API supports payment-related products including collection and disbursement, and the developer portal documents sandbox and production-style integration paths.

8. Wallet and earnings dashboard

Artists should see payments received, pending withdrawals, transaction history, and payout status. This is critical because payout transparency is one of the strongest differentiators you can build.

9. Payout system

The platform should allow creators to withdraw earnings to MTN Mobile Money wallets. MTN's disbursement support makes this technically realistic, subject to the operational setup and compliance requirements of the specific market.

10. Tipping and micro-support

Fans should be able to send small payments to artists as direct support. This is a strong fit for emerging creators because it monetizes even small communities.

11. Subscriptions and memberships

Artists can offer paid fan access to exclusive tracks, early releases, or premium content. This gives creators more than one revenue stream and avoids dependence on streaming alone.

12. Promotions and featured placements

Artists can pay for boosted visibility or featured slots. This is useful for early-stage monetization and can help creators get discovered faster.

13. Playlist and curation tools

Admins or curators can build playlists by genre, mood, region, or rising talent category. Curation helps solve the visibility problem that large platforms often handle poorly for small artists.

14. Notifications

Users get alerts for uploads, tips, follows, comments, and payouts. This improves retention and helps artists respond quickly to fan activity.

15. Admin moderation panel

Admins can approve tracks, reject copyrighted content, handle abuse, and manage disputes. This is necessary because copyright and payout trust are major risks in music platforms.

16. Analytics dashboard

Artists and admins can track streams, engagement, revenue, top songs, and conversion rates. Analytics help creators understand what content works and how to grow.

17. Copyright and takedown handling

The system should allow reporting, review, and removal of disputed tracks. This is a core risk-control feature for any music platform.

Feature Priority Order

Phase 1: Must-have MVP

These are the first features to build:

1. User registration and login.
2. Artist onboarding.
3. Music upload and storage.
4. Public artist profiles.
5. Basic streaming and playback.
6. Search and discovery feed.
7. MTN Mobile Money payment collection.
8. Basic earnings dashboard.
9. Basic admin moderation.

Phase 2: Revenue expansion

After MVP validation, add:

1. Fan tipping.
2. Creator withdrawals to MTN Mobile Money.
3. Paid subscriptions or memberships.
4. Featured placements and promotions.
5. Playlist curation.
6. Push notifications.
7. Engagement tools like follow and comment.

Phase 3: Growth and scale

Add these after traction:

1. Advanced analytics.
2. Recommendation engine.
3. Automated copyright reporting.
4. Multi-country support.
5. Multi-currency support.
6. Partner dashboards for promoters and labels.
7. In-app campaigns and referral systems.

Step-by-step build process

Step 1: Define the MVP scope

Pick one country, one target artist segment, and one primary payment flow. MTN's API guidance shows that API support varies by market and product, so narrowing scope reduces integration risk.

Step 2: Build authentication and profiles

Create user sign-up, login, artist account types, and profile pages. This gives structure to the platform before music and payments are added.

Step 3: Build upload and storage

Implement music upload, file validation, artwork upload, metadata fields, and track publishing. This is the content foundation of the app.

Step 4: Build playback and discovery

Add the music player, search, categories, trending content, and artist discovery feed. Without discovery, artists will not get the exposure that makes the platform valuable.

Step 5: Integrate MTN Mobile Money collection

Implement payment collection for tipping, subscriptions, and premium content. MTN's MoMo API documents collection and request-to-pay style flows for receiving payments.

Step 6: Build earnings tracking

Show a dashboard for money received, pending balance, completed transactions, and payout history. This is one of your main differentiators because artists need trust and transparency.

Step 7: Add payouts

Enable withdrawals from the platform wallet to MTN Mobile Money. MTN's disbursement support makes creator payouts practical once compliance and account setup are complete.

Step 8: Add moderation and compliance

Build copyright reporting, admin review, takedown tools, and content approval. Music platforms need this early because legal and trust risks grow quickly.

Step 9: Add fan monetization tools

Introduce tipping, subscriptions, paid releases, and featured artist support. These features strengthen the platform's business model beyond simple streaming.

Step 10: Add analytics and growth tools

Add performance dashboards, referral tracking, trend insights, and campaign tools. Once content and payments are working, analytics will help optimize growth and revenue.

Suggested Database Modules

- Users.
- ArtistProfiles.
- Tracks.
- Albums/Playlists.
- Streams.
- Payments.
- WalletTransactions.
- Withdrawals.
- Follows.
- Comments.
- Reports.
- Notifications.
- Promotions.

Suggested Tech Modules

- Frontend app.
- Backend API.
- File storage service.
- Audio streaming service.
- Payment integration layer.
- Admin dashboard.
- Analytics service.
- Notification service.

Key Risks

The biggest risks are licensing, copyright abuse, payout errors, fraud, and slow user adoption. These risks justify building moderation, payout tracking, and market validation into the first release rather than postponing them.

Success Metrics

- Number of artist signups.
- Number of uploaded tracks.
- Monthly active listeners.
- Payment conversion rate.
- Total creator earnings.
- Withdrawal completion rate.
- Artist retention.
- Track engagement rate.

Final Recommendation

Build this as a creator monetization platform first and a streaming platform second. If you focus on young talent, local discovery, transparent payouts, and MTN Mobile Money, you will have a much stronger market position than a general-purpose music app.

MONITIZATION AND PREMIUM PLAN STRATEGY EXPLAIN

Yes — the right way to do this is to build a **freemium + creator monetization** system, where the app works for free at the basic level, but advanced tools and earning features are locked behind paid plans. Your premium system should be controlled by server-side access rules, not just hidden buttons in the UI, so users only unlock features after a valid payment is confirmed.

Monetization plan

1. Free plan

This is the entry level for all users. Fans can browse, listen, follow artists, and share music, while artists can create an account, upload limited tracks, and view basic stats. The goal is to let users experience value before asking them to pay.

2. Artist Starter plan

This is for new artists who want more uploads, better visibility, and basic monetization tools. It can include extra upload slots, simple analytics, and access to tipping or paid track sales.

3. Artist Pro plan

This is the main paid tier for serious creators. It can include unlimited or high-limit uploads, advanced analytics, featured promotion tools, better payout priority, custom profile branding, and access to premium marketing tools.

4. Fan Support plan

This is for listeners who want exclusive content, early releases, badges, private rooms, or ad-free listening. You can also use this for subscription-based access to select artist content.

5. Promotion credits

Artists can buy promotion credits separately from subscriptions. These credits can be used to boost a song, pin content, or appear in trending sections. This creates flexible revenue and works well for users who do not want monthly billing.

Premium feature structure

The premium features should work like this:

- The user sees the feature in the UI.
- If the user is free, the feature is visible but disabled or partially locked.

- When the user taps it, the app shows an upgrade screen.
- After payment is confirmed, the backend changes the user's subscription status.
- The app checks that status and unlocks the feature.

That is the most important principle: the feature must be controlled by the backend, not only by front-end hiding. A user should not be able to bypass premium access by editing the interface or using a direct URL.

How to build premium access

Step 1: Create plan tables

Create database tables for users, plans, subscriptions, and entitlements. Each user should have a plan field or linked subscription record showing whether they are free, starter, pro, or fan support.

Step 2: Define entitlements

An entitlement is the list of features a plan can access. For example, Pro users may have "advanced analytics," "promotion credits," and "unlimited upload," while Free users only have "basic listening" and "limited upload."

Step 3: Build a payment flow

When a user clicks upgrade, send them to the MTN Mobile Money payment process. After payment, your backend receives confirmation and activates the selected plan. MTN's developer platform and MoMo API are designed for payment collection and related integration flows.

Step 4: Use webhook or callback verification

Do not activate premium access immediately on the front end. Wait until the payment callback or webhook confirms that the transaction succeeded, then update the user's subscription in your database.

Step 5: Protect routes and APIs

Every premium screen, API endpoint, and backend action should check whether the user has the correct entitlement before allowing access. This applies to analytics pages, upload limits, featured promotions, and payout tools.

Step 6: Update the UI dynamically

Once the backend marks the user as premium, refresh the app state and unlock the feature immediately. If the subscription expires, downgrade the access automatically.

Example premium features

Advanced analytics

Show plays, saves, shares, audience location, revenue trends, and conversion stats. This should be hidden behind Artist Pro because it is a high-value creator tool.

Unlimited uploads

Free users can upload a small number of tracks, while premium users can upload more or without a cap. This is a strong upgrade trigger because artists usually hit storage or release limits quickly.

Featured promotion

Premium users can boost songs to the homepage or discovery feed. You can tie this to monthly plan benefits or sell it as separate credits.

Payout tools

Premium users can get faster withdrawal processing, payout history, and better earning dashboards. This adds real value because it connects directly to revenue.

Fan exclusive content

Fans on a paid plan can access early releases, private sessions, and special badges. This works well because it monetizes loyalty rather than just traffic.

Recommended pricing structure

A practical starting structure in XAF could look like this:

- Free: 0 XAF.
- Artist Starter: low monthly fee.
- Artist Pro: higher monthly fee.
- Fan Support: low monthly fee.
- Promotion credits: one-time purchase.

You should start with simple pricing and adjust after testing conversion rates.

Build order

1. Build authentication and user roles.
2. Build the free version of the app.

3. Create plan records and entitlement logic.
4. Integrate MTN Mobile Money payment verification.
5. Lock premium routes and actions on the backend.
6. Build upgrade screens and pricing pages.
7. Add analytics, promotions, and fan support features.
8. Test expiration, renewal, failed payment, and downgrade flows.

Important rule

Never make premium access depend only on hiding buttons in React. The real lock must be enforced in your API and database, because front-end controls can be bypassed.

Best approach for your app

Start with one strong premium package for artists, one for fans, and one optional promotion-credit model. That gives you recurring revenue, one-time revenue, and a clean upgrade path without making the app too complicated too early.

OPTION 2

Below is a full implementation document you can use as your project master file. I structured it like a real software project document, with product goals, scope, features, architecture, database, monetization, and a step-by-step delivery plan in priority order.

Implementation Document

1. Project Title

Music Streaming and Creator Monetization Platform with MTN Mobile Money. The platform is designed for young and emerging artists to upload music, get discovered, and earn money directly from fans.

2. Project Overview

This project is a creator-first music platform that combines streaming, artist promotion, and digital payments. Its main purpose is to solve the gap between artist visibility and artist income by giving young talent a place to publish content and monetize it through direct fan support.

3. Problem Statement

Many emerging artists struggle to get visibility on major streaming platforms, and even when they get plays, earnings are often too small or too indirect. The platform solves this by adding local payment support, creator earnings dashboards, and premium tools that help artists earn from fans more directly.

4. Project Objectives

- Allow artists to upload and manage music.
- Let fans discover, stream, and support artists.
- Integrate MTN Mobile Money for payments and payouts.
- Offer premium creator tools and fan membership plans.
- Provide analytics, promotion, and monetization tools.

5. Scope of the System

The first version should launch in one country or a small MTN-supported region, not across all markets at once. The initial scope should focus on artist uploads, streaming, discovery, payment collection, creator payouts, and premium access control.

6. Target Users

- Young and emerging artists.
- Fans who support local music.
- Admins who moderate content and manage payouts.
- Promoters or curators who feature new talent.

7. Core Features

7.1 Free user features

- Register and log in.
- Browse and stream music.
- Follow artists.
- Share tracks.
- View limited artist pages.

7.2 Artist features

- Create an artist profile.

- Upload music and artwork.
- Edit metadata and releases.
- View basic analytics.
- Receive direct fan tips.
- Request payouts.

7.3 Premium artist features

- Unlimited or expanded uploads.
- Advanced analytics.
- Featured promotion slots.
- Custom branding.
- Faster payout visibility.
- Campaign tools and audience insights.

7.4 Premium fan features

- Early access to tracks.
- Exclusive content.
- Ad-free listening.
- Fan badges.
- Membership communities.

8. Monetization Model

The app owner earns from commissions on payments, premium artist subscriptions, fan subscriptions, promotion credits, and possibly advertising later. The strongest early revenue streams are transaction commission, premium creator accounts, and paid promotion features.

9. Premium Access Logic

Premium access must be enforced by the backend, not only by the front end. A user pays, the payment is confirmed through the MTN Mobile Money flow, the backend updates the subscription status, and the app unlocks the purchased features based on entitlement checks.

10. Functional Requirements

- User authentication.
- Role-based access control.
- Artist onboarding.
- Track upload and management.
- Playback and discovery.
- Payments and wallet integration.
- Subscription management.
- Payout processing.
- Notifications.
- Admin moderation.
- Analytics reporting.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

- Fast loading on mobile networks.
- Secure payment handling.
- Scalable architecture.
- Reliable uptime.
- Content moderation support.
- Responsive UI.
- Strong data privacy and access control.

12. System Architecture

The system should use a client-server model with a React front end, a Node.js/Express backend, a database for users and transactions, and cloud storage for audio files. MTN Mobile Money should be connected through server-side API calls, with payment confirmation updating subscription and wallet records.

13. Main Modules

- Authentication module.
- Artist profile module.

- Upload module.
- Streaming module.
- Discovery module.
- Payment module.
- Subscription module.
- Wallet and payout module.
- Admin module.
- Analytics module.
- Notification module.

14. Database Design

Core tables

- Users.
- ArtistProfiles.
- Tracks.
- Albums.
- Playlists.
- Streams.
- Payments.
- Subscriptions.
- WalletTransactions.
- Withdrawals.
- Promotions.
- Notifications.
- Reports.

Important subscription fields

- userId.

- planName.
- status.
- startDate.
- endDate.
- paymentReference.
- entitlementLevel.

15. Payment Flow

1. User selects a plan or support action.
2. App sends payment request through MTN Mobile Money.
3. MTN returns transaction status.
4. Backend verifies success.
5. Subscription or wallet balance is updated.
6. Premium access is unlocked automatically.

16. Premium Feature Enforcement

Each premium action must call an authorization check before execution. For example, the analytics screen, upload-limit endpoint, promotion endpoint, and payout endpoint should all verify whether the user plan includes those rights.

17. Content Moderation

The admin panel should allow track review, copyright reports, takedowns, and abuse handling. This is necessary because music platforms face legal and trust issues if copyrighted or harmful content is not controlled.

18. Analytics and Reporting

Artists should be able to see plays, likes, shares, tips, subscriptions, earnings, and conversion rate. Admins should see total traffic, top artists, payment totals, and plan performance.

19. Security Considerations

- Use JWT or secure session auth.
- Validate payment callbacks on the server.
- Protect premium APIs with entitlement checks.

- Encrypt sensitive data.
- Log payment and payout events.
- Apply rate limiting and abuse protection.

20. Development Phases

Phase 1: MVP foundation

- Authentication.
- Artist onboarding.
- Track upload.
- Streaming.
- Discovery.
- Basic admin moderation.

Phase 2: Monetization

- MTN Mobile Money integration.
- Tips.
- Subscriptions.
- Premium plan checks.
- Earnings dashboard.
- Payouts.

Phase 3: Growth

- Analytics.
- Featured promotions.
- Fan communities.
- Notifications.
- Referral system.
- Expanded curation tools.

Phase 4: Scale

- Multi-country support.
- Better recommendation engine.
- Ad system.
- Partner portals.
- Advanced fraud and copyright controls.

21. Step-by-Step Build Order

1. Define plans and entitlements.
2. Build authentication and roles.
3. Create artist profiles.
4. Build upload and storage.
5. Build playback and discovery.
6. Add payment collection.
7. Confirm payment and activate plans.
8. Add premium route protection.
9. Build wallet and payout logic.
10. Add analytics and admin controls.
11. Add promotions and subscriptions.
12. Test, fix, and deploy.

22. Recommended MVP Priorities

Highest priority

- Login and registration.
- Artist account creation.
- Music upload.
- Streaming player.
- Discovery feed.
- MTN payment integration.

- Subscription verification.

Medium priority

- Tipping.
- Artist wallet.
- Payout requests.
- Basic analytics.
- Content moderation.

Later priority

- Paid promotions.
- Fan clubs.
- Advanced analytics.
- Ads.
- Multi-country rollout.

23. Expected Business Outcome

If executed well, the platform can become a local creator economy product that earns from payments, premium tools, and artist growth services. The strongest positioning is not “a Spotify clone,” but a platform that helps young talent grow and earn directly.

24. Risks and Mitigation

- Copyright risk: add moderation and takedown tools.
- Low adoption: launch with a narrow niche and country.
- Payment failure: verify callbacks and retries.
- Weak revenue: use multiple monetization streams.
- User bypass of premium: enforce backend entitlement checks.

25. Conclusion

This project is feasible, commercially interesting, and technically realistic if you build it in stages and keep the first release focused. The most important idea is to combine discovery, creator monetization, and reliable local payments into one clear product

Below is a well-structured dashboard document for your platform. It lists each actor, the roles assigned to that actor, and the tasks they perform from their dashboard when navigating those roles. The structure follows common music-platform and admin-dashboard patterns used in streaming and creator tools.

Actor Dashboard Roles and Tasks

1. Visitor Dashboard

A visitor is a user who has not signed up yet. This dashboard is mostly public and acts as the entry point into the platform.

Roles and tasks

- Browse landing pages.
- View featured artists and trending music.
- Search public artist profiles.
- Read about premium plans.
- Create an account or sign in.

2. Listener / Fan Dashboard

This dashboard is for registered fans who listen to music and support artists. It should be simple, fast, and centered on discovery, engagement, and payments.

Roles and tasks

- Stream music.
- Search songs, albums, and artists.
- Follow or unfollow artists.
- Like, comment, and share tracks.
- Create and manage playlists.
- Tip artists using MTN Mobile Money.
- Subscribe to premium fan plans.

- Access exclusive or early-release content.
- View listening history and saved items.
- Manage account settings and notifications.

3. Artist Dashboard

This dashboard is for creators who upload and manage their music. It should focus on publishing, revenue, audience growth, and promotion.

Roles and tasks

- Create and edit artist profile.
- Upload songs, albums, and cover art.
- Add metadata such as title, genre, description, release date, and tags.
- Edit or remove uploaded content.
- View stream counts and fan engagement.
- Track earnings and payout status.
- Request withdrawal to MTN Mobile Money.
- Launch paid promotions or featured placements.
- Read fan feedback and comments.
- View audience insights and analytics.
- Manage subscription plan and upgrade options.

4. Premium Artist Dashboard

This dashboard is for artists who have purchased a paid plan. It contains everything in the normal artist dashboard, plus locked premium tools that improve growth and monetization.

Roles and tasks

- Access advanced analytics.
- View detailed revenue breakdowns.
- Use unlimited or expanded upload limits.
- Promote tracks from the dashboard.
- Unlock branded profile customization.

- See fan conversion and subscription data.
- Access priority support.
- Manage exclusive premium campaigns.
- Track performance by region and audience segment.

5. Admin Dashboard

The admin dashboard is the control center for the whole platform. It is used to supervise users, content, monetization, and system health.

Roles and tasks

- View platform overview statistics.
- Manage users and artist accounts.
- Approve or reject uploaded content.
- Handle reports and copyright complaints.
- Moderate comments and abuse cases.
- Review payment issues and failed transactions.
- Manage featured music and homepage content.
- Track revenue and subscription activity.
- Send announcements and platform notifications.
- Monitor system performance and logs.

6. Super Admin Dashboard

This is the highest-level control panel. It is for the platform owner or top system manager and includes sensitive administrative and configuration tasks.

Roles and tasks

- Create and manage admin accounts.
- Define user roles and permissions.
- Configure monetization rules.
- Set subscription prices and plan features.
- Control payment gateway settings.

- Manage platform-wide policies.
- View audit logs and security records.
- Control feature flags and system modules.
- Manage integrations and global settings.
- Oversee strategic platform performance.

7. Promoter / Curator Dashboard

This dashboard is for people who help push music into the right audience. It focuses on discovery, curation, and promotional support.

Roles and tasks

- Create playlists and collections.
- Feature selected artists.
- Recommend songs for trending sections.
- Run promotional campaigns.
- Organize talent showcases.
- Track campaign performance.
- Monitor which songs are gaining traction.
- Support artist visibility strategies.

8. Payment Gateway Dashboard

This is the external payment actor, mainly MTN Mobile Money, but the platform can also have an internal payment control area. It handles the financial side of user purchases and creator payouts.

Roles and tasks

- Process user payments.
- Confirm successful transactions.
- Support collections for subscriptions and tips.
- Support disbursements for artist payouts.
- Return payment status to the platform.

- Trigger webhook or callback responses.
- Help validate failed or pending transactions.

9. Notification Service Dashboard

This can be a system panel or internal service area for platform alerts. It helps the app keep users informed and engaged.

Roles and tasks

- Send upload confirmations.
- Notify artists of tips and subscriptions.
- Alert users about new releases.
- Send payout notifications.
- Broadcast admin announcements.
- Notify about failed payments or renewals.
- Deliver engagement alerts such as likes and comments.

10. Analytics Dashboard

This dashboard is used by artists, admins, and super admins to understand performance. It should present data visually and support decision-making.

Roles and tasks

- Show stream statistics.
- Display revenue charts.
- Show subscriber growth.
- Compare track performance.
- Track fan engagement.
- Monitor conversion rates.
- Analyze top-performing content.
- Review geographic and demographic insights.

Recommended dashboard structure by actor

Listener dashboard sections

- Home.
- Discover.
- Search.
- Library.
- Playlists.
- Support artists.
- Subscriptions.
- Settings.

Artist dashboard sections

- Overview.
- Upload music.
- My releases.
- Earnings.
- Payouts.
- Promotions.
- Analytics.
- Settings.

Admin dashboard sections

- Overview.
- Users.
- Content moderation.
- Payments.
- Reports.
- Analytics.
- Settings.
- Audit logs.

Best way to use this in your project

You should treat each dashboard as a role-based workspace. After login, the system should detect the user role and redirect them to the correct dashboard, then only show the tasks allowed for that role. That keeps the app clean, secure, and easy to use

USERS WANTS

Below is a structured feature backlog for your music platform, written to help you plan, prioritize, and build in a practical order. It focuses on user demand, market gaps, monetization, and implementation effort, which are the same factors product teams use when ranking backlog items.

Feature Backlog Document

1. Product Goal

Build a creator-first music platform where young artists can upload music, grow an audience, and earn money directly through MTN Mobile Money. The backlog is organized to maximize early value, reduce risk, and support a realistic MVP.

2. Prioritization Method

This backlog uses a simple value-vs-effort approach combined with MVP thinking. Features that solve urgent user pain, generate revenue, or reduce platform risk are ranked first, while advanced or optional items are ranked later.

3. Backlog Legend

- Priority 1 = Must build first.
- Priority 2 = Should build after MVP.
- Priority 3 = Nice to have later.
- Effort: Low, Medium, High.
- Value: High, Medium, Low.

4. Feature Backlog Table

ID	Feature	Main Actor	User Need / Market Gap	Priority	Value	Effort	Why it matters
F01	User registration and login	Visitor, Listener, Artist	Basic access and identity	1	High	Low	Required for all dashboards and role-based access.
F02	Role-based dashboard routing	All users	Show correct workspace per role	1	High	Medium	Prevents confusion and supports secure access.
F03	Artist profile creation	Artist	Visibility and identity	1	High	Low	Foundation for uploads and discovery.
F04	Music upload and publishing	Artist	Content creation	1	High	Medium	Core supply-side feature.
F05	Music playback / streaming	Listener	Listening and discovery	1	High	Medium	Core user value.
F06	Search and discovery feed	Listener, Visitor	Find talent easily	1	High	Medium	Solves weak discovery for young artists.
F07	MTN Mobile Money payment collection	Listener, Artist	Local payments	1	High	High	Needed for monetization and creator support.
F08	Subscription / plan purchase flow	Listener, Artist	Upgrade access	1	High	Medium	Enables premium revenue.
F09	Backend entitlement checks	System	Lock premium access	1	High	Medium	Prevents free access to paid features.
F10	Basic artist earnings dashboard	Artist	Earnings transparency	1	High	Medium	Builds trust with creators.
F11	Admin moderation panel	Admin	Content safety	1	High	Medium	Needed for copyright and

ID	Feature	Main Actor	User Need / Market Gap	Priority	Value	Effort	Why it matters
							abuse control.
F12	Tipping / micro-support	Listener	Direct support to artists	2	High	Medium	Strong monetization gap opportunity.
F13	Payout request to MTN wallet	Artist	Withdraw earnings	2	High	High	Completes the earning loop.
F14	Fan subscriptions / memberships	Listener	Exclusive access	2	High	Medium	Recurring revenue and superfans.
F15	Paid exclusive content	Artist, Listener	Unlock special tracks	2	High	Medium	Monetization and fan loyalty.
F16	Featured promotions / boosts	Artist	Better visibility	2	High	Medium	Artists pay for exposure.
F17	Follow / unfollow artists	Listener	Stay connected	2	Medium	Low	Increases retention and engagement.
F18	Likes, comments, shares	Listener	Social engagement	2	Medium	Low	Supports discovery and community.
F19	Notifications system	All users	Engagement alerts	2	Medium	Medium	Improves retention.
F20	Basic analytics for artists	Artist	Track growth	2	High	Medium	Helps creators improve performance.
F21	Playlist creation	Listener	Organize music	2	Medium	Medium	Common user expectation.
F22	Curated playlists by genre/city	Curator, Admin	Discovery and promotion	2	High	Medium	Helps surface young talent.
F23	Artist story /	Artist,	Authenticity	3	Medium	Low	Matches what

ID	Feature	Main Actor	User Need / Market Gap	Priority	Value	Effort	Why it matters
	behind-the-track cards	Listener	and context				users want more of.
F24	Live streaming / fan Q&A	Artist, Listener	Direct artist connection	3	High	High	Strong community feature, but heavier build.
F25	Fan clubs / private communities	Artist, Listener	Superfan engagement	3	High	High	Good for recurring revenue.
F26	Advanced analytics	Premium Artist	Deep performance insight	3	High	High	Valuable, but not needed for MVP.
F27	Recommendation engine	System	Personalized discovery	3	High	High	Useful after more user data exists.
F28	Merch or ticket sales	Artist, Listener	In-app commerce	3	Medium	High	Great later revenue stream.
F29	Copyright reporting and takedown workflow	Admin	Legal protection	2	High	Medium	Important for platform safety.
F30	Referral system	All users	Growth and acquisition	3	Medium	Medium	Helps user growth later.

5. Must-Build Features First

These are the highest priority because they form the core product:

- Registration and login.
- Role-based dashboard access.
- Artist profiles.
- Upload and streaming.
- Search and discovery.

- MTN Mobile Money payments.
- Premium access control.
- Basic earnings dashboard.
- Admin moderation.

6. Why These Come First

These features solve the biggest market gaps: discovery, monetization, and trust. If you build them first, you can test whether artists upload, fans listen, and payments actually happen before spending time on advanced features.

7. High-Value Features Next

After the MVP, the next most useful features are tipping, subscriptions, paid content, featured promotion, notifications, and analytics. These features create the first real revenue engine for the platform and improve retention.

8. Later-Stage Features

Features such as live streaming, fan clubs, recommendation engines, and merch sales are powerful, but they need more traffic, more trust, and more infrastructure. They should be added after the app proves strong usage and monetization.

9. Recommended Dashboard Placement

- Visitor dashboard: F01, F06, F30.
- Listener dashboard: F05, F06, F12, F14, F17, F18, F19, F21.
- Artist dashboard: F03, F04, F10, F13, F15, F16, F20, F23, F24, F26, F28.
- Admin dashboard: F11, F22, F29.
- Super admin dashboard: plan control, access control, payment settings, system config.
- Payment service: F07, F08, F09, F13.

10. Suggested Delivery Order

Sprint 1

- Authentication.
- Role routing.
- Artist profile.

- Basic UI shells.

Sprint 2

- Upload system.
- Streaming player.
- Search and discovery.

Sprint 3

- MTN payment integration.
- Subscription plans.
- Entitlement protection.

Sprint 4

- Earnings dashboard.
- Admin moderation.
- Copyright reporting.

Sprint 5

- Tipping.
- Payouts.
- Notifications.

Sprint 6

- Promotions.
- Analytics.
- Fan memberships.

11. Feature Selection Rule

If a feature does one of these, move it up the backlog:

- Helps users discover talent.
- Helps artists earn money.
- Builds trust and safety.

- Increases retention.
- Improves conversion to paid plans.

12. Final Recommendation

Do not overload the first version with too many advanced social or AI features. Build the money loop first: artist uploads music, fans discover it, fans pay, artists get paid, and the app owner earns commission and premium fees